

Speaker Notes – Team 05: Cameroon and Sri Lankan Tamil Cultures

Slide 1 – Title

Welcome everyone. Today we will discuss intercultural cooperation, cultural diversity and sustainability through a comparison of Cameroonian and Sri Lankan Tamil cultures. Our goal is to understand how cultural values influence communication, teamwork and sustainable development.

Slide 2 – Table of Contents

Briefly introduce the presentation structure: introduction, cultural background, iceberg model, Hofstede dimensions, and sustainability through SDGs, workplace scenarios, conclusion and discussion.

Slide 3 – Introduction

Ask the audience how cultural differences affect teamwork. Explain that diversity creates opportunities for creativity and innovation, but can also cause misunderstandings if people interpret behavior differently.

Slide 4 – Why These Two Cultures?

Introduce Cameroon and Sri Lanka on the world map. Although they are geographically distant, both have strong community-oriented cultures and provide an interesting comparison for intercultural cooperation.

Slide 5 – Hierarchy & Deference

Explain that both cultures show respect for authority. In Cameroon authority is often visible and assertive. In Sri Lanka respect is shown more quietly through formal structures. Emphasize the importance of giving feedback respectfully.

Slide 6 – High-Context Communication

Describe how both cultures rely on indirect communication. Cameroonians tend to be expressive and relationship-oriented, while Sri Lankan Tamils often avoid direct confrontation to preserve harmony and dignity.

Slide 7 – Trust vs Transaction

Discuss negotiations. In Cameroon trust and personal relationships are often built before business. In Sri Lanka decisions may take time because consultation and protocol are important. Building trust is critical in both contexts.

Slide 8 – Internal Sub-Blocs

Explain cultural diversity within each country. Cameroon has Anglophone and Francophone influences. Sri Lanka has multiple ethnic and linguistic groups. Organizations should develop context-sensitive policies.

Slide 9 – Power Distance

Present the chart. Both cultures generally accept hierarchy and authority. Employees often expect leaders to make important decisions. Compare this with the lower power distance perceived at HSRW.

Slide 10 – Individualism vs Collectivism

Explain that both cultures are relatively collectivist. Family, community and group interests are often prioritized over individual goals. HSRW is perceived as more individualistic.

Slide 11 – Motivation Towards Achievement and Success

Compare achievement orientation. Cameroon tends to place greater emphasis on achievement, status and success. Sri Lankan culture balances achievement with family welfare and social harmony.

Slide 12 – Indulgence vs Restraint

Discuss self-control and gratification. Sri Lankan culture is generally more restrained, encouraging moderation and long-term thinking. Cameroon shows comparatively greater openness to enjoyment and social expression.

Slide 13 – Hofstede Summary

Summarize the four dimensions. Highlight similarities in hierarchy and collectivism while noting differences in achievement orientation and indulgence. Connect these findings to workplace behavior.

Slide 14 – SDG 11 Sustainable Cities

Explain how collectivist values support community resilience. Strong family ties, religious organizations and community cooperation help both societies respond to challenges and contribute to sustainable communities.

Slide 15 – SDG 4 Quality Education

Discuss how respect for teachers and structured learning environments support education. Mention advantages such as discipline and commitment, but also possible limitations such as reduced questioning and critical discussion.

Slide 16 – SDG 5 Gender Equality

Compare gender equality. Both countries are progressing, but women remain underrepresented in leadership. Sri Lanka has high female literacy, while Cameroon continues improving access to education. Cultural expectations still influence opportunities.

Slide 17 – SDG 12 Responsible Consumption

Explain how cultural restraint can support sustainable consumption. Reuse, repair and long-term resource use help reduce waste. Mention growing consumer pressures in both societies.

Slide 18 – Boss and Employee Scenario

Explain how cultural expectations regarding hierarchy may influence communication between managers and employees. Emphasize respect and clear communication.

Slide 19 – Colleague Relationship Scenario

Discuss teamwork among colleagues. Differences in communication style can create misunderstandings. Encourage active listening, empathy and respect for cultural differences.

Slide 20 – Conclusion

Summarize the main message: understanding cultural values improves cooperation and supports sustainability. Cultural diversity should be viewed as a strength rather than a barrier.

Slide 21 – Thank You

Thank the audience for their attention and acknowledge contributions from all team members.

Slide 22 – Questions & Discussion

Invite questions. Encourage discussion about similarities, differences and how cultural awareness can improve international teamwork and sustainability efforts.